

HotTips Installation and Process Guide

Installing HotTips

Step 1: Download the Installer

The HotTips installer is available through the official HotTips GitHub repository. Follow the instructions below to download and install the application.

Opening the HotTips GitHub Page

1. Open an internet browser on your computer.
Examples:
 - Google Chrome
 - Microsoft Edge
 - Firefox
2. Click the address bar at the top of the browser window.
3. Enter the following web address:
<https://github.com/SebLoaiza/HotTips>
4. Press the **Enter** key on your keyboard.

The HotTips GitHub page will open. This page contains the application files and the latest available versions of the software.

Finding the Latest Release

1. Once the HotTips GitHub page has loaded, locate the **Releases** section.
2. The Releases section is located on the right side of the GitHub page.
3. Click the latest available release.

Example:

HotTips v1.0.0

The latest release contains the most recent version of the application installer.

Downloading the Installer File

1. On the release page, scroll down until you find the section labeled:

Assets

2. Under Assets, locate the installer file:

HotTips.Setup.1.0.0.exe

3. Click on **HotTips.Setup.1.0.0.exe** to begin downloading the installer.
 4. Wait for the download to complete.
-

Locating the Installer

After the download finishes:

1. Open your computer's Downloads folder.
2. Locate the file:

HotTips.Setup.1.0.0.exe

3. The file should appear as an application installer file.
-

Running the Installer

1. Double-click:

HotTips Setup.exe

2. Windows may display a security warning before opening the installer.

If this occurs:

1. Click **More Info**.
2. Click **Run Anyway**.

This allows Windows to continue running the HotTips installer.

Installing HotTips

After the installer opens Wait while the application install.

Opening HotTips

After installation:

1. Locate the HotTips shortcut on your desktop.
OR
2. Open the Windows Start Menu and search for:

HotTips

3. Double-click the application to launch it.

HotTips is now installed and ready to use.

Troubleshooting

If the installer does not open:

1. Verify that the file downloaded completely.
2. Try downloading the installer again.
3. Restart the computer and retry the installation.

If Windows blocks the installer:

1. Select **More Info**.
2. Select **Run Anyway**.

If additional issues occur, contact the application administrator for assistance.

Running HotTips

Starting a New Process

After opening HotTips, the main screen will display the available options.

To begin processing a new set of tip information:

1. Open HotTips from the Start Menu.
2. On the main screen, select:

Start New Process

Selecting this option will open the Toast Input page.

The Toast Input page is where the required Toast CSV files are uploaded before HotTips can process employee shifts, sales, payments, and tip information.

Toast Input Requirements

HotTips requires three CSV files exported from Toast:

1. **Time Entry Management CSV**
 - Used for employee shift information.
 - Uploaded into HotTips under the **Shifts CSV upload**.
2. **Orders CSV**
 - Used for order and sales information.
 - Uploaded into HotTips under the **Order CSV upload**.
3. **Payments CSV**
 - Used for payment method and payment information.
 - Uploaded into HotTips under the **Payments CSV upload**.

All three CSV files must be generated using the **same date range**.

For example:

If you are processing May 1st through May 7th:

- Time Entry Management must be May 1st - May 7th
- Orders must be May 1st - May 7th
- Payments must be May 1st - May 7th

Using different date ranges can cause incorrect tip calculations.

Exporting the Time Entry Management CSV

The Time Entry Management report contains employee clock-in and clock-out information.

Steps:

1. Log into Toast.
2. Navigate to:

Reports → Labor → Time Entry Management

3. Set the date range to the desired processing period.
4. Confirm the date range matches the date range that will be used for Orders and Payments.
5. Click:

Apply

6. Change the table display settings to show:

All

This ensures the complete report is displayed.

7. Download the CSV file.
8. Save the file somewhere easily accessible.

When uploading into HotTips, this file should be selected as:

Shifts CSV

Exporting the Orders CSV

The Orders report contains sales and order information.

Steps:

1. In Toast, navigate to:

Reports → Sales → Orders

2. Set the date range to the exact same date range used for Time Entry Management.
3. Click:

Apply

4. Change the table display settings to:

All

5. Download the CSV file.
6. Save the file.

When uploading into HotTips, this file should be selected as:

Order CSV

Exporting the Payments CSV

The Payments report contains payment information needed for tip calculations.

Steps:

1. In Toast, navigate to:

Reports → Payments → Payments

(Note: The Payments section appears twice in the navigation path.)

2. Set the date range to the exact same date range used for:
 - Time Entry Management
 - Orders
3. Click:

Apply

4. Change the table display settings to:

All

5. Download the CSV file.
6. Save the file.

When uploading into HotTips, this file should be selected as:

Payments CSV

Uploading Toast CSV Files into HotTips

Return to the HotTips Toast Input page.

Upload each file into the matching input field:

Toast Export	HotTips Upload Field
Time Entry Management CSV	Shifts CSV
Orders CSV	Order CSV
Payments CSV	Payments CSV

After all three files have been uploaded:

1. Verify that each file is attached to the correct input field.
2. Continue to the next step in HotTips.

HotTips will now process the uploaded information and begin creating the tip distribution data.

Understanding the Dynamic Tables

The tables in HotTips are created dynamically based on the uploaded information.

This means:

- More employees will create additional rows.
- More dates will create additional columns.
- Additional meal periods will populate their own sections.
- Additional uploaded information will automatically update existing tables.

The user does not need to manually add employees, dates, or shifts.

Important Notes

- Always export all three Toast reports using the same date range.
- Always set the Toast tables to display **All** before downloading.
- Do not rename CSV columns or modify the CSV files before uploading.
- Uploading incorrect or mismatched CSV files may result in incomplete or inaccurate tip calculations.

Manual Inputs

After the Toast data has been uploaded and processed, HotTips will move to the **Manual Inputs** page.

The Manual Inputs page is divided into three tabs:

1. **Cash Drops Grid**
2. **Employee Config**
3. **Summary**

These tabs allow the user to enter required manual information, configure employee settings, and review the information before continuing.

The required order of completion is:

1. Complete the **Cash Drops Grid**
2. Complete the **Employee Config**
3. Review the **Summary**
4. Continue to the next step

Important: Cash Drops must be completed before entering Employee Config. Employee configuration should only be completed after all required cash drop values have been reviewed and entered.

Tab 1: Cash Drops Grid

Purpose

The Cash Drops Grid is used to enter the amount of cash collected during each meal period.

Cash drops must be completed first because these values are required for accurate cash tip calculations.

Entering Cash Drops

Important: Cash Drops must be completed before entering Employee Config. Employee configuration should only be completed after all required cash drop values have been reviewed and entered.

1. Open the **Cash Drops Grid** tab.
2. Locate the appropriate:
 - Date
 - Meal period
 - Cash drop entry cell
3. Enter the amount of cash collected for that specific period.
4. Continue entering cash drops until all required values have been entered.

The grid automatically organizes information by:

- Date
- Meal period
- Shift

Users do not need to manually create rows or columns.

Navigating the Cash Drops Grid

The Cash Drops Grid supports keyboard navigation to make entering multiple values faster.

While entering cash amounts:

- Press **Enter** to move down to the next row.

- Press **Tab** to move to the next column on the right.

Example workflow:

1. Enter the cash drop amount for the first cell.
2. Press **Enter** to move to the next row.
3. Press **Tab** to move across to the next date or column.
4. Continue entering values until all cash drops are completed.

Keyboard navigation only changes the selected cell location and does not modify any entered values.

Negative Cash Drop Warnings

HotTips will highlight cash drop cells in **red** when the entered value becomes negative.

A negative value indicates that the entered cash amount may not match the expected cash calculation.

Example:

- Entered value: **-\$25.00**
- Cell displays as red

Important: Red highlighted cells are warnings only.

HotTips will **not prevent the user from continuing** if there are red cells.

If a cell is red:

1. Review the entered amount.
 2. Confirm that the value is correct.
 3. Continue only after verifying the information.
-

Tab 2: Employee Config

Purpose

The Employee Config tab is used to configure employee settings before final tip calculations are performed.

Important: Do not enter Employee Config until all Cash Drops have been completed.

Employee Config relies on the completed cash drop information and should be the second step in the Manual Inputs process.

Assigning Trainers

All trainees must have a trainer assigned before continuing.

To assign a trainer:

1. Open the **Employee Config** tab.
2. Locate the employee who requires a trainer.
3. Select the trainer dropdown next to that employee.
4. Choose the appropriate trainer.
5. Repeat this process for all employees who require trainer assignments.

Important: Every trainee must have a selected trainer before the process can continue.

Employee Point System

The Employee Point System determines the default weighting value assigned to each employee for the current processing period.

The point system is displayed on the side of the Employee Config page.

These values determine the default employee share used during tip distribution calculations.

Editing Employee Points

Employee point values are automatically loaded using the default configuration.

The user may adjust these values if needed.

To edit employee points:

1. Locate the employee.
2. Select or edit their point value.
3. Enter the desired value.
4. Confirm the updated value is correct.

Changes made here only apply to the current processing period.

Continuing After Employee Configuration

After all required trainers have been assigned:

1. The **Continue** button will become available.
2. Review the employee configuration settings.
3. Confirm all trainees have an assigned trainer.
4. Click:

Continue

HotTips will move to the next stage of the process.

Tab 3: Summary

Purpose

The Summary tab provides a final overview of the information entered before continuing.

Review the summary to confirm:

- Cash drops were entered correctly.

- Employee configurations are correct.
- Trainer assignments are complete.
- Employee point values are correct.

If changes are needed:

1. Return to the appropriate tab.
 2. Update the information.
 3. Review the Summary again.
-

Final Reminders

Before continuing, verify:

- Cash Drops have been fully completed.
- Any red cash drop cells have been reviewed.
- All trainees have an assigned trainer.
- Employee point values are correct.

Once these items are complete, the process can continue.

Tip Distribution

Purpose

The Tip Distribution page is where HotTips calculates and displays the final distribution of tips for each employee.

This page is used to:

- Review each meal block.
- Verify employee distributions.
- Adjust employee-specific settings when needed.
- Confirm that tips are being distributed to the correct roles and employees.

The Tip Distribution page is one of the most detailed pages in HotTips because it displays every employee, meal period, role, point value, and calculated distribution.

Navigating the Tip Distribution Page

The information on this page is organized by:

1. **Day**
2. **Meal Period**
3. **Employee Role**

Because each day contains multiple meal periods, the page can become very large.

To make navigation easier:

- Each day has its own tab.
- Each day contains three meal blocks:
 - Breakfast
 - Lunch
 - Dinner

Example:

June 27, 2026

Contains:

- Breakfast - June 27, 2026
- Lunch - June 27, 2026
- Dinner - June 27, 2026

Select the appropriate day tab to review that day's distributions.

Reviewing a Meal Block

Each meal block contains several sections.

A typical meal block includes:

1. Tip Pool Summary
2. Tip Owners
3. Servers
4. BOH
5. Bussers
6. Hosts

7. Other

Tip Pool Summary

At the top of each meal block is the pool summary.

This displays how much tip money is available for each distribution group.

Example:

Pool	Cash	Card
Servers	Amount	Amount
BOH	Amount	Amount
Bussers	Amount	Amount
Hosts	Amount	Amount

This section shows where tips are being distributed.

Tip Owners

The Tip Owners section displays employees who are receiving final payouts from the meal block.

This section shows:

- Employee name
- Employee role
- Distribution role
- Net card tips
- Cash tips
- Tips received from each pool
- Total kept

The **Total Kept** value represents the final calculated amount the employee receives after distributions.

Employee Distribution Sections

Below Tip Owners are the individual role sections.

These sections include:

- Servers
- BOH
- Bussers
- Hosts
- Other

Each employee row displays:

- Employee name
 - Job role
 - Distribution role
 - Shift time
 - Tip points
 - Pool card received
 - Pool cash received
 - Trainer
-

Editable Information

The Tip Distribution page is primarily a review page.

The only editable employee information is:

1. Meal Block Specific Tip Points

Employee tip points can be adjusted for a specific meal block.

Example:

An employee may have:

- Monday Breakfast: 1 point

- Monday Lunch: 0.75 points
- Monday Dinner: 1 point

Changing points in one meal block does not affect other meal blocks.

This allows adjustments for situations where an employee's contribution was different for a specific shift.

2. Distribution Roles

Employees can have their distribution role changed.

The available distribution roles are:

- Tip Owner
 - Server
 - Busser
 - Host
 - BOH
 - Other
-

Distribution Roles Explained

Tip Owner

Tip Owners are employees who directly receive tips from the meal block.

These employees typically include employees who are actively participating in tip distribution.

Server

Servers receive from the server tip pool.

Employees assigned as Server will participate in server distributions.

Busser

Bussers receive from the busser tip pool.

This role is used for employees supporting service operations.

Host

Hosts receive from the host tip pool.

This role is used for employees managing guest seating and hosting responsibilities.

BOH

BOH means Back of House.

This role is used for kitchen employees and receives from the BOH tip pool.

Examples:

- Line cooks
 - Prep cooks
 - Dishwashers
-

Other

The Other role is used for employees who should not receive any tip pool distribution.

Employees assigned to Other:

- Receive \$0 from tip pools.
- Are excluded from normal distributions.

This role can also be used temporarily for employees who need their role corrected.

Example:

An employee defaults to Other but should receive BOH tips.

Changing their role from:

Other → BOH

will allow them to participate in the BOH tip pool.

Important: Trainees and Trainers

Trainer assignments are displayed in the employee information section.

If an employee requires a trainer relationship, verify that the correct trainer is displayed.

Incorrect trainer assignments may affect distribution calculations.

Reviewing Distributions

For each day:

1. Select the day tab.
2. Review Breakfast.
3. Review Lunch.
4. Review Dinner.
5. Check employee roles.
6. Verify unusual point values.
7. Confirm that employees are assigned to the correct distribution pools.

Repeat this process for each day being processed.

Before Continuing

Before selecting **Continue**, verify:

- All employees are assigned the correct distribution role.
- Meal block points are correct.
- Employees assigned to Other are intentionally excluded.

- Tip pools are distributing to the expected employees.
- No required adjustments remain.

Once all meal blocks have been reviewed:

Click:

Continue

HotTips will proceed to final payout calculations.

Final Results

Purpose

The Final Results page is the final stage of the HotTips process.

This page displays the completed tip distribution after all previous steps have been completed:

- Toast data has been imported.
- Cash drops have been entered.
- Employee configurations have been completed.
- Meal block distributions have been reviewed.

The Final Results page provides the final employee payout information and serves as the final review before payroll processing.

Payroll Summary

The main feature of the Final Results page is the **Payroll Summary**.

The Payroll Summary displays the final calculated take-home amounts for each employee.

This includes the completed results from:

- Card tips
- Cash tips
- Tip pool distributions
- Employee role assignments
- Meal block point values

Reviewing Employee Results

Each employee will have a summary row displaying their final payout information.

Review each employee to verify:

- Employee name
- Total tips earned
- Cash received
- Card tips received
- Final take-home amount

The final take-home amount represents the amount the employee should receive after all distributions have been calculated.

Final Verification

Before completing the process, review the Payroll Summary and confirm:

- All expected employees are listed.
- No employees are missing.
- Take-home amounts appear reasonable.
- Employees who should not receive tips are showing the correct amount.
- Any previous adjustments were reflected correctly.

If an employee's result appears incorrect:

1. Return to the previous pages.
 2. Review:
 - Employee Config settings.
 - Meal block roles.
 - Tip points.
 - Cash drop entries.
 3. Make any necessary corrections.
 4. Return to Final Results to verify the updated calculations.
-

Completing the Process

Once the Payroll Summary has been reviewed and confirmed:

1. The tip distribution process is complete.
2. The Payroll Summary can be used for payroll records.
3. The final employee take-home amounts are ready for processing.

The Final Results page represents the completed calculation of all tip distributions within HotTips.